

Swarmfront Roadmap: Hive Gauntlet & Competitive PvE Modes

Hive Gauntlet is a proposed competitive PvE pillar for Swarmfront. Rather than fighting live opponents, players compete asynchronously by playing the same maps, facing the same bots, and progressing through the same challenge structure. Rankings are determined by stars, progression, survival, or tournament rules. This creates a highly replayable mode that complements Live PvP, Async PvP, and SSR tournaments.

Core Concept

10 or more players enter the same event. Every player receives identical maps, bot behavior, and progression requirements. Results are compared after completion. This allows meaningful competition without requiring simultaneous matchmaking.

Star Rating System

Each map awards 1–3 stars based on completion performance. Example: 3 Stars = elite completion time 2 Stars = strong completion time 1 Star = completed 0 Stars = failed Stars can be used as progression requirements, rankings, tie-breakers, or qualification criteria.

Mode 1: Classic Gauntlet

All entrants complete the same sequence of maps. Final ranking is determined by total stars earned across all maps. Simple, easy to understand, and highly replayable.

Mode 2: Survival Run

Players continue advancing through increasingly difficult maps until they fail. Rankings: 1. Highest map reached 2. Total stars earned 3. Fastest completion time Creates dramatic leaderboard competition and long-term mastery.

Mode 3: Top-Half Prize Pool

All entrants play the full event. The top 50% of performers receive a share of the prize pool. This encourages participation while reducing winner-take-all frustration.

Mode 4: Pole Vault

Players must earn 3 stars to advance. Anyone earning fewer than 3 stars is eliminated. The field narrows each round until only a few competitors remain. Stars become both progression and elimination mechanics. Highly spectator-friendly and unique among tower-style games.

Seasonal Variants

Different rule sets can rotate weekly or monthly: - Classic Stars - Survival - Pole Vault - Top Half - Experimental Formats Most popular formats can become permanent playlists.

Free Play & Money Games

Every format can exist in: - Free Play - Honey Entry Events - Cash Entry Events (where permitted)
The same underlying framework supports multiple business models.

Long-Term Vision

Hive Gauntlet becomes a fourth pillar of Swarmfront alongside: 1. Live PvP 2. Async PvP 3. SSR Tournaments 4. Hive Gauntlet The system creates a competitive arcade experience using the existing lane-control gameplay engine, maximizing development efficiency while expanding retention and replayability.